

Family Motto and Crest

The Rothschild family crest was created according to the rules of heraldry and includes symbolism unique to the family. There is a clenched fist with five arrows symbolizing the five sons of Mayer Rothschild and a reference to Psalm 127: “Like arrows in the hands of a warrior.” There is a red shield in the middle, as the name “Rothschild” derives from the German *roten Schild* (literally, “red shield”). The family motto appears below the shield: *Concordia, Integritas, Industria* (Harmony, Integrity, Industry).

If you don’t already have a family motto and crest, consider what they might be. Remember, these should reflect qualities that are unique to your family and help promote your family identity.

Family Traditions and Rituals

Family traditions are important because they are unique expressions of your family identity. They also give a sense of permanence and stability. The more unique activities you can do with family members that they enjoy and take seriously, the better.

Family rituals and celebrations for family members reaching certain milestones help strengthen family bonds and the sense of belonging. For example, when a new family member joins the Family Council, this is an opportunity for a family rite of passage.

The Jewish bar/bat mitzvah is a great example of this. In the Episcopal Church, confirmation is a similar coming-of-age ritual. You should consider having similar rituals for young people entering your Family Council and other “soft structure” institutions (more on that in Chapter 8).

Beware of allowing family members to opt out of family events. Certainly, there will be periods when individual family members need to “do their own thing.” But, ideally, this should be in addition to the family activities, not a substitute for them.

Family Relationships and Reputation

Family relationships and the family reputation are critical manifestations of your family’s identity. These things can take decades and sometimes